given to camp in the ground amid the town while Babur himself was given his father's houses in the outer fort.

Taṃbal Reaches Out to Shaybāni Khān

Taṃbal delegated his elder brother Beg Tīlba to meet Shaybāni Khān. The intent was to offer service, thereby inviting him to enter Ferghana. To not render Taṃbal hopeless, he replied, 'I will come.'

This news was not going to bode well for Khāns and Babur. It left them perturbed as well as upset. They could no longer afford the comfort of the Andijān. The younger Khān cherished his reputation for delivering justice and respecting traditions. But Moghūls under him, stationed in Osh, Marghīnān, etc. places conquered by Babur, had begun to adopt bullying tactics, against the expectations of the people of the town. They had turned highly oppressive. And then when the Khāns broke up from before Andijān, the Oshis and Marghīnānīs erupted in uproar. An uproar seemed buried under some soft soil.

They seized the Moghūls in their forts. They were plundered and beaten in the worst manner possible. And finally shown the way out from there.

The Khāns were careful not to cross the Khujand-water (for the Kīndīrlīk-pass), rather they left the country via Marghīnān and Kand-i-badām, crossing it at Khujand. Taṃbal chased them as far as Marghīnān. Not only Babur and his men but the Khāns too seemed to be devoid of confidence. Babur was uncertain about his next stand. But he was certainly in no mood to go away, without clear reason, and leave them. He was worried about his reputation, too.

Bābur Fights to Defend Akhsī

The circumstances were not very conducive then. It was one very early morning. Babur was lying in his hot bath when Jahāngīr Mīrzā escaped from Taṃbal and arrived at Akhsī after fleeing from Marghīnān. A meeting took place between the two. Shaikh Bāyazīd was present there as well. Shaikh appeared agitated and afraid to see Mīrzā arriving. The Mīrzā and Ibrāhīm Beg were very clear about what needs to be done to Shaikh Bāyazīd. Mīrzā said, 'Shaikh Bāyazīd must be made prisoner and we must get the citadel into our hands.'